TCS Global Travel & Domestic Business Expense Policy

CATEGORY	Finance & Global Mobility | Travel Administration	EFFECTIVE DATE	January 1, 2026	REVIEW CYCLE	Annual Tata Corporate Audit

Article 1. Business Travel Governance, Pre-Approval & Ultimatix GTS Integration

1.1 Travel Authorizations, Global Travel System (GTS) Mandate & Approval Matrix

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) recognizes that business travel is critical for client project execution, business development, executive leadership reviews, and knowledge transition across our global enterprise. This policy establishes standardized rules, eligibility entitlements, per diem schedules, and expense settlement parameters for all domestic and international business travel undertaken by TCS associates. All business travel must be strictly necessitated by business exigencies and authorized prior to travel.

All travel requisitions must be raised, routed, and ticketed exclusively through the TCS Ultimatix Global Travel System (GTS) / Concur platform. Self-booking via public retail travel websites, personal airline portals, or unauthorized agents is strictly prohibited and will not be reimbursed. Domestic travel requests must be approved by the Project Manager (PM) and Delivery Head (DH) at least 7 calendar days in advance; international travel requests require Delivery Center Head (DCH) and Global Travel Desk signoff at least 21 calendar days prior to departure.

Travel Classification	Advance Notice SLA	Required Approval Tier	Ticketing Channel
Domestic Intra-State Travel	Minimum 5 Calendar Days	Project Manager & Delivery Lead	Ultimatix GTS Portal Only
Domestic Inter-State Travel	Minimum 7 Calendar Days	Delivery Head (DH) Approval	Ultimatix GTS Portal Only
Short-Term Overseas Travel (STT)	Minimum 21 Calendar Days	DCH & Overseas Business Head	Corporate GTS Travel Desk
Client-Billable Travel	Minimum 7 Calendar Days	Client SOW & Project Manager	GTS with Client Billing Code
Emergency Escalation Travel	Minimum 24 Hours SLA	Unit Delivery Head Direct Signoff	Emergency Desk Ticketing

- Travel tickets booked outside Ultimatix GTS without explicit prior CFO dispensation will be rejected by corporate finance.
- Associates must ensure all project billability codes and customer accounting centres are accurately mapped in the travel requisition.
- Frequent Flyer Miles (FFM) earned during official travel may be retained by the associate for personal use, provided no additional cost is incurred.

ULTIMATIX GTS BOOKING COMPLIANCE MANDATE:
All flight, train, hotel, and car bookings must be processed through corporate travel tie-ups in Ultimatix. Any expense incurred through unauthorized travel portals without pre-trip approval is classified as non-reimbursable personal expenditure.

Article 2. Domestic Airfare, Train Travel & Ground Transportation Entitlements

2.1 Travel Modes by Grade Band, Economy Class Standards & Rail Travel Classes

Travel mode eligibility is structured according to the associate's grade band, travel distance, and transit duration. For all domestic travel within India, commercial air travel is permitted for flight sectors where the flight duration exceeds 2.5 hours or the rail journey duration exceeds 6 hours. All domestic flights must be booked in Economy Class via the most direct, logical, and cost-effective commercial flight option available on the Ultimatix GTS portal.

For rail travel, associates in Bands Y, C1, and C2 are entitled to AC 2-Tier / AC 3-Tier sleeper berths; associates in Bands C3, C4, and C5 are entitled to AC 1st Class or Executive Chair Car on Vande Bharat and Shatabdi Express services. Executive Leadership (Vice Presidents and above) are entitled to Economy Air for all domestic flights and Business Class on international flights where continuous flying time exceeds 8 hours.

Associate Grade / Band	Domestic Air Entitlement	Train Travel Entitlement	International Flight Class
Bands Y, C1, C2 (ASE / SE / ITA)	Economy Class (> 2.5h / > 500km)	AC 2-Tier / AC 3-Tier / AC Chair Car	Economy Class (Lowest Fare)
Bands C3A, C3B (AST / ASC)	Economy Class (All domestic flights)	AC 1st Class / AC 2-Tier / Exec Chair Car	Economy Class (Lowest Fare)
Bands C4, C5 (Consultant / Sr. Cons)	Economy Class (All domestic flights)	AC 1st Class / Exec Chair Car	Premium Economy (> 6h flight)
Vice President / Global Heads	Economy Class (Lowest Fare)	AC 1st Class / Executive Chair Car	Business Class (> 8h flight)
Executive Leadership (CXO)	Economy / Business Class	AC 1st Class Executive	Business Class (Direct Route)

- Flight tickets must be booked at least 14 days in advance wherever schedules permit to optimize corporate advance-purchase discounts.
- Airlines offering corporate web-check-in baggage allowances must be selected; excess personal baggage charges are not reimbursed.
- Airport transfers should utilize authorized TCS transport desks, pre-paid airport taxis, or corporate cab services.

TRAVEL MODE GOVERNANCE PROTOCOL:
Upgrades to business class or premium cabs at corporate expense are strictly prohibited without written approval from the Global Head of Delivery. Any unauthorized upgrade fare difference will be recovered directly from monthly payroll.

Article 3. Hotel Accommodations, Daily Allowances (DA) & Per Diem Rates

3.1 City Tiers, Negotiated Corporate Stays & Daily Allowance Rates

TCS maintains preferred corporate hospitality tie-ups with reputable hotel chains—including Ginger Hotels, Taj Group partner properties, Lemon Tree, and approved business hotel chains across India. All hotel accommodations must be booked through the Ultimatix GTS hotel portal at corporate negotiated rates. Direct walk-in hotel bookings are strictly prohibited.

Daily Allowance (DA) covers meals (breakfast, lunch, dinner), incidentals, tips, and daily laundry during official tours. DA rates are categorized into Tier 1 Metro Cities (Mumbai, Delhi-NCR, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata), Tier 2 Cities (Pune, Ahmedabad, Kochi, Chandigarh, Jaipur, Indore), and Tier 3 / Other Locations. If hotel accommodation includes complimentary breakfast, or if client-sponsored meals are provided, the daily allowance is reduced proportionally.

City Category / Location Tier	Hotel Nightly Room Cap (excl. GST)	Daily Allowance (DA) / Per Diem	Conveyance Daily Cap
Tier 1 - Metro (Mumbai, Delhi, BLR, HYD, MAA)	Up to Rs 3,500 / Night	Rs 1,500 / Full Day	Rs 1,000 / Day (Corporate Cab)

Tier 2 - Non-Metro (Pune, CCU, COK, AMD, JAI)	Up to Rs 2,500 / Night	Rs 1,200 / Full Day	Rs 800 / Day (Corporate Cab)
Tier 3 - Other Urban Locations	Up to Rs 1,800 / Night	Rs 900 / Full Day	Rs 600 / Day (Local Auto / Cab)
International Travel - US / Europe ($ / €)	Up to $180 / €160 per Night	$75 / €70 per Diem (Full Day)	Actual Local Transit
International Travel - APAC / ME ($)	Up to $140 / Night	$60 per Diem (Full Day)	Actual Local Transit

- Room service charges, in-room mini-bar consumables, and pay-per-view movies are personal expenses and will not be reimbursed.
- Itemized hotel tax invoices displaying the TCS Corporate GSTIN number must be collected upon checkout for input tax credit.
- For tours lasting less than 12 hours, 50% of the daily allowance is admissible; full DA applies for tours exceeding 12 hours.

GST COMPLIANCE INVOICING MANDATE:
All hotel and local travel bills must carry the exact legal name 'Tata Consultancy Services Limited' and the state-specific TCS GSTIN number. Bills lacking corporate GST details cannot be reimbursed under statutory Indian tax audit guidelines.

Article 4. Local Conveyance, Mileage Reimbursement & Corporate Cab Governance

4.1 Corporate Cab Tie-Ups, Personal Vehicle Mileage & ODC Commute Rules

Local conveyance during official tours or authorized inter-branch client visits must utilize TCS corporate cab tie-ups (Uber for Business / Ola Corporate / pre-paid airport taxi counters). The corporate profile must be selected during booking so that rides are billed directly to the project cost centre. Personal rides must never be billed to the corporate account.

Where an associate utilizes their personal vehicle for pre-authorized business travel (e.g., attending client meetings or visiting sister delivery campuses where corporate transport is unavailable), mileage reimbursement is admissible at the rate of Rs 8.00 per km for four-wheelers (cars) and Rs 4.00 per km for two-wheelers (motorcycles/scooters). Mileage claims must be substantiated with toll receipts, odometer start/end readings, and precise Google Maps route printouts.

Conveyance Mode	Reimbursement Rate / Cap	Required Substantiating Document	Approval SLA
Corporate Cab (Uber / Ola)	Actual corporate rate billed	Electronic trip receipt with business purpose	Automated Billing
Personal Four-Wheeler (Car)	Rs 8.00 / Kilometer	Odometer logs, toll receipts & route printout	PM Approval Required
Personal Two-Wheeler (Bike)	Rs 4.00 / Kilometer	Odometer logs & route printout	PM Approval Required
Airport Express Metro / Bus	Actual fare incurred	Original transit card receipt / e-ticket	Fast-track Approval
Daily Commute (Home to Office)	Zero (Non-reimbursable personal cost)	Not Applicable (Disallowed)	Strict Auto-Rejection

- Daily commuting costs between the associate's residence and their base TCS campus are strictly personal and non-reimbursable.
- Traffic fines, parking violation penalties, and vehicle maintenance costs are the associate's sole personal liability.
- Toll charges incurred during authorized business mileage trips are reimbursed in full upon uploading FASTag/toll statements.

VEHICLE MILEAGE GOVERNANCE:
Associates claiming personal vehicle mileage must possess a valid driving license, active comprehensive vehicle insurance, and valid PUC certification. Claims for daily home-to-office commute under the guise of official travel trigger audit recovery.

Article 5. Expense Settlement Windows, Invoicing & Financial Reconciliation

5.1 15-Day Expense Claim Submission, GST Mandate & Automated Audit Scanning

All travel and business expense claims must be compiled, documented with itemized tax invoices, and submitted through the Ultimatix Expense Claim module within 15 calendar days of the completion of the business trip or expense incurrence. Claims submitted beyond 15 days require written justification and Delivery Head (DH) approval; claims submitted beyond 45 days are strictly time-barred, forfeited, and automatically rejected by corporate finance.

All uploaded vouchers undergo automated AI audit scanning and forensic duplicate-invoice checks. Original tax invoices displaying the merchant's GSTIN, invoice date, itemized description, and tax breakdown must be attached. Claims containing handwritten un-itemized slips exceeding Rs 250 are disallowed. Verified claims are disbursed electronically to the associate's salary bank account during the subsequent bi-weekly reimbursement payroll cycle.

Claim Stage	Timeframe / Window	Action Required	Consequence of Non-Compliance
Standard Claim Submission	Within 15 Calendar Days of Tour	Submit e-claim in Ultimatix with all tax invoices	Processed in next reimbursement cycle
Delayed Submission Window	16 to 45 Calendar Days	Requires Delivery Head (DH) written dispensation	Delayed reimbursement processing
Strict Forfeiture Threshold	> 45 Calendar Days from Tour	Claim permanently locked & archived in Ultimatix	100% Personal associate forfeiture
Advance Reconciliation	Within 15 Days of Tour Completion	Surplus advance refund / expense offset	Recovery from monthly salary if delayed

- Travel advances remaining unsettled past 30 days are automatically recovered from the associate's next monthly salary.
- Fraudulent or inflated expense claims result in immediate disciplinary dismissal under Tata Code of Conduct Clause 4.
- Corporate audit retains all digital expense vouchers and audit trails for a statutory retention period of 8 financial years.

ZERO-TOLERANCE EXPENSE FRAUD POLICY:
Submitting fabricated hotel bills, forged taxi receipts, or duplicate claims across multiple projects constitutes criminal fraud. Offenses are immediately referred to the Central Ethics Committee and result in summary dismissal and legal action.

Document Governance, Audit History & Tata Code of Conduct Authorization

Revision	Release Date	Author / Department	Summary of Regulatory Changes
v1.0	Jan 15, 2024	TCS Global HR Taskforce	Initial codification of associate policies aligned with Tata Code of Conduct (TCoC) and statutory labor standards.
v2.0	Nov 10, 2024	Corporate Ethics & Compliance	Updated statutory maternity/paternity protections, POSH ICC inquiry guidelines, and bereavement leave rules.

v3.0	Jan 01, 2025	TCS Total Rewards Council	Bouquet of Benefits (BoB) tax optimization, NPS corporate Tier 1 integration, and TCS Health Insurance Scheme (TCS-HIS) enhancement.
v4.0	Oct 15, 2025	Delivery Operations & Workplace	Codified 5-day return-to-office (RTO) attendance linkage with quarterly performance pay (QPP) and Secure Borderless Workspaces (SBWS).
v6.0	Jan 01, 2026	Chief Human Resources Officer & Legal	Annual consolidation. ISO 27001 ISMS controls, Generative AI acceptable usage governance, and Ultimatix ESS automation.

Signatory Role	Authorized Representative	Approval Status	Digital Signature Hash
Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)	Milind Lakkad	APPROVED & RATIFIED	SHA256: 7f8a9b2c3d4e5f6a7b8c9d0e1f2a3b4c5d6e7f8a...tcs001
General Counsel & Ethics Officer	S. Venkataramanan, Esq.	COMPLIANCE VERIFIED	SHA256: 9b2c3d4e5f6a7b8c9d0e1f2a3b4c5d6e7f8a9b0c...tcs002
Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	Samir Seksaria, FCA	FISCAL BUDGET RATIFIED	SHA256: 3d4e5f6a7b8c9d0e1f2a3b4c5d6e7f8a9b0c1d2e...tcs003
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